Nicole Esther Lee

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Computer science student with a design background who plans and runs usability tests and turns what users do into clear recommendations.

EDUCATION

Singapore Institute of Technology – DigiPen Institute of Technology Singapore
Bachelor of Science in Computer Science in Interactive Media and Game Development *Aug 2023 – 2027 (expected)*

Millennia Institute Singapore
GCE A-Levels, including Art *Feb 2020 – Nov 2022*

RESEARCH PROJECTS

Nyx: Dreams of the Stray – Playtesting a 3D Narrative Level Jun 2025
Unreal Engine 5 · Usability testing · Grade A

- Planned and ran 6 moderated playtests across 3 builds, observing where players hesitated, got lost or got frustrated, and recording their verbal feedback in a structured report after each session
- Analysed qualitative notes alongside quantitative measures (session time, falls per section) to find patterns across testers, such as paths that felt too linear and a jump section that was too punishing
- Turned findings into design changes each round; session time rose from 3:09 to 7:48 and falls in the hardest section dropped from 5 to 0

Makan Kaki – Group Lunch Ordering App (in progress) Oct 2026
Figma · Research planning

- Wrote a research plan for CBD office workers: an interview guide built on past behaviour, a recruiting checklist for 5 participants, and an affinity map with four themes for synthesis
- Framed the problem around two user groups (organisers and colleagues), listed untested assumptions to validate, and mapped both groups' journeys before designing

Level Editors for Friends Frog-ever & Chroma Aug 2024 – Apr 2026
C++ game engines · Level Editor Lead

- Gathered workflow needs from design students who used our engine tools, and translated them into editor features with the engineering team

Tick – Design System for a Crypto Trading App Oct 2026
Figma · Design evaluation

- Audited an AI-generated design system against my spec, logged defects with before/after evidence, and turned them into clear fix recommendations

Also: Whispers of the Garden, a cooperative card game designed for children and families with special needs (graded A)

EXPERIENCE

DBS Bank Singapore
Site Reliability Engineer Intern, Global Financial Markets Technology *May 2026 – Present*

- Run UAT with development and infrastructure teams before releases
- Analyse system logs with the ELK stack to spot patterns and issues early; automate scheduled reports and email alerts with Bash and Power Automate

SKILLS

Research: Usability testing, moderated playtests, interview guides, research planning, observation notes, affinity mapping, qualitative and quantitative analysis, personas, user journeys
Design & tools: Figma, user flows, wireframes, prototyping, Jira, Notion
Communication: Written playtest reports, slide presentations of design plans, working with engineers and designers